ZikShare

ACADEMIC VAULT

UNIZIK FRESHER EDITION | 2026

THA 122: Basic Performance Skills - Body, Voice and Presence

A practical studio companion for your first acting and movement classes

THEATRE & FILM

Theatre & Film Studies

Faculty of Arts
Theatre & Film Studies | 100L

OUTLINE ARCHIVE: 2018 - 2019 - 2025/2026

Written for students, by students.

Practical notes, worked examples, practice questions and a revision plan.

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Independent study support | Not an official UNIZIK publication

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Why this pack exists

Performance skills are built by repetition, not by inspiration. This pack sets out a safe studio routine, explains the body-awareness approaches referenced in the department's course description - Stanislavskian, Suzukian and Laban - and gives you a rehearsal log that makes your progress visible.

This is a student-written study companion, not a reproduced lecture handout or a leaked examination paper. Use it to organise the topics you are taught, practise the kind of thinking your course rewards, and walk into class with better questions.

What you will be able to do

- Warm up the body and voice safely before studio work.
- Explain the difference between Stanislavskian, Suzukian and Laban approaches.
- Use objectives, actions and given circumstances to build a short scene.
- Keep a rehearsal log that documents choices and corrections.

How to use this pack

1. Skim the whole pack once in 20 minutes so you know what is inside.
2. Work through one section at a time with your lecture note and recommended text beside you.
3. Attempt the practice questions before reading the answers. Mark what you missed.
4. Use the final checklist to plan your revision week, one tick per study session.

> **Free to download, always**
> This pack is free. There is no fee, no subscription and no payment step before download, and the full PDF is not watermarked or locked. Share the link with a coursemate instead of forwarding the file.

> **Confirm your official course outline**
> Course codes, credit units and outlines can differ by department and session. Treat this pack as supplementary support and confirm the current outline with your lecturer, course rep or departmental handbook before an assessment.

Studio discipline

The studio is a workplace with physical risk. Prepare properly or you will be injured and marked down.

- Warm up joints, spine and breathing before any movement work.
- Remove jewellery and wear clothing that allows movement.
- Bare feet or non-slip footwear only on a studio floor.
- Hydrate and take breaks; fatigue causes sloppy habits and injury.
- Respect physical boundaries; agree contact before exercises.
- Cool down and note any strain in your log.

Three approaches you will meet

Each approach answers a different question about how performance becomes truthful or expressive.

- Stanislavski: given circumstances, objectives, actions and emotional truth; asks what the character wants now.
- Suzuki: intense lower-body strength, stamping and vocal power; trains presence and stamina.
- Laban: effort qualities of weight, time, space and flow; builds a vocabulary for movement.
- None is the single correct method; technique serves the production's demands.
- Name the approach in your log so your development is legible to a tutor.
- Never imitate an advanced exercise you have not been trained to do.

> **Objective plus action**
> A playable choice sounds like 'to persuade her to stay' rather than 'to be sad'. Emotion is a by-product of pursuing an objective.

Rehearsal log and scene work

Tutors assess process as much as the final showing.

- Record date, exercise, what you attempted and what changed.
- Note one correction from your tutor verbatim, then how you applied it.
- For scene work, list your objective, obstacle and action beats.
- Score the scene in beats rather than trying to play one emotion throughout.
- Review the log weekly and identify a pattern in your notes.
- Film yourself once a fortnight; the camera exposes habits the mirror hides.

OUTLINE ARCHIVE

Session record: THA 122

2018 - 2019 - 2025/2026

Year demarcation matters: a course code that existed in 2018 may have been renumbered, merged or dropped by 2019, and the department now also runs a film track. Read the year label before you rely on a code. The current entry below is a compiled map - take it to your course rep or the departmental office and confirm it before registration.

2018 Archived course description

ARCHIVED

- The 2018 description covers basic artistic skills for the beginning actor and performer
- Body awareness in specified methods - Stanislavskian, Suzukian and Labanesque characterisations
- Graded studio exercises and field information used to stimulate imagination

What changed: The 2018 page pairs body and space awareness with named performance methods rather than a separate movement course.

Source: unizik.edu.ng - Theatre & Film Studies course description (page dated 31 May 2018; original URL now returns 404) (retrieved 2026-10-22)

2019 Archived programme listing

ARCHIVED

- THA 122 Basic Performance Skills, 3 credits, second semester, 100 level
- The 2019 listing also introduces THA 153 Communication Models and THA 161 Participation Orientation
- Performance work sits beside THA 142 Introduction to Dance Theatre in Africa

What changed: THA 122 is introduced in the 2019 listing; the 2018 description referenced performance skills without that code.

Source: arts.unizik.edu.ng - Theatre Arts programme and course map (page dated 18 Oct 2019; original URL now returns 404) (retrieved 2026-10-22)

2025/2026 Compiled working map

CURRENT WORKING MAP

- Basic performance skills remains a 100-level studio core in the compiled map
- Expect assessment on process, logbook and showing, not only final performance
- Confirm studio dress and safety rules with your tutor before the first session

Source: Compiled by ZikShare from the archived 2018 and 2019 departmental pages plus the published stress areas; this is a working map, not an official handout (retrieved 2026-10-22)

Archive means: this records what a public departmental page listed in that year. It is not a guarantee of the current curriculum, and ZikShare is not affiliated with UNIZIK.

PRACTICE, NOT PREDICTION

Check your understanding

These questions are written for this pack to test the ideas above. They are not past examination questions and do not predict what your lecturer will set. Answer first, then compare.

1. What is a playable objective?

Answer: A specific want directed at another character in the scene, phrased as an action, for example 'to get him to admit he lied'.

2. Name the four effort qualities in Laban's movement analysis.

Answer: Weight, time, space and flow.

3. Why does Suzuki training emphasise the lower body?

Answer: It builds grounding, stamina and vocal support, producing a physically present performer.

4. What belongs in a rehearsal log entry?

Answer: Date, exercise, what you attempted, what changed, feedback received and how you applied it.

5. Why score a scene in beats?

Answer: Beats break the scene into playable units with changing objectives, preventing a single flat emotion across the whole scene.

Your 7-step action plan

Tick each step only when you have done it. A tick you cannot defend is worse than an empty box.

- [ ] Learn and rehearse a ten-minute warm-up you can do alone.
- [ ] Write objectives for three short scenes.
- [ ] Keep a rehearsal log for four sessions.
- [ ] Film one exercise and review it critically.
- [ ] Read a short introduction to Stanislavski's system.
- [ ] Practise one Laban effort quality across three exercises.
- [ ] Ask your tutor to correct one habit and record the correction.

Keep going

One pack will not carry a semester. Pair this with your lecture notes, tutorials, and the past questions your department actually releases. If a topic still feels unclear, take a specific question to your lecturer or course rep - "I do not understand the difference between X and Y" gets a better answer than "I do not understand this course".

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YOUR WORKSPACE

Notes, questions and things to ask

Use this page in class or during revision. Write questions you could not answer instead of copying slides.

Three ideas I can now explain without notes:

A question I still cannot answer:

For my lecturer or course rep:

Next revision action and date: